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3 Closes That Work

Free sample from The Sales Rep Starter Kit

Word-for-word scripts · when to use them · common mistakes · practice drills

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3 Closes That Work

From my desk to yours — I've spent over 20 years on dealership floors, and these are three closes I still use every week. They're pulled word-for-word from The Sales Rep Starter Kit, my full 10-step sales process. No tricks, no pressure tactics — just honest questions that help people decide.

HOW TO USE THIS SAMPLE

Work one close per shift. Say the scripts out loud until they sound like you, fill in the brackets with the real customer in front of you, and never read from the page. Grade yourself against each close's checklist after every real attempt.

THE HONESTY RULE

Never say something untrue. If you offer to hold a vehicle, hold it. If you promise a call, call. If you can't deliver a number, say so. These closes work because they keep the trust intact — the moment you use them to hide something, they stop working.

WHAT'S INSIDE

- ☐ 1. The Direct Ask Close — what to say when the test drive went well and it's time to move forward.
- ☐ 2. The “What’s Giving You Pause?” Close — the honest way to handle “I want to think about it.”
- ☐ 3. The Choice Close — how to trade value for value and find the win-win at the desk.
- ☐ Each close: when to use it, the word-for-word script, why it works, the mistake to avoid, and a quick practice drill.

Want the whole process? The Starter Kit walks through all 10 steps — from the first greeting to the follow-up call — with scripts, checklists, and a 7-day practice plan. Details on the last page.

1 The Direct Ask Close

GOAL — Ask for the next step directly, right when the customer is excited and the fit is clear.

From the Starter Kit: Step 5 — Review Test Drive Feedback

WHEN TO USE IT

The test drive is over, you've sat back down with them, and they're talking about the car like it's already theirs. That's your moment to ask for the next step — before the energy fades and before you pile on more information they didn't ask for.

WHAT TO SAY

“It sounds like this one fits. What would you want to happen next to move forward?”

WHY IT WORKS

It's a question, not a demand — so it never feels pushy. It treats the customer like the decision-maker, which they are, and it gives you a straight answer about where the deal really stands. If they're ready, they'll tell you. If they're not, you've learned that early, honestly.

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Asking too early, before they've shown real interest — it comes across as pressure and the customer shuts down.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Only use it after clear signs of fit: they loved the drive, they keep talking about the car, they're asking next-step questions.
- ☐ Ask the question exactly as written — then stop talking.
- ☐ Listen to the answer; reflect it back: “That makes sense.”
- ☐ If they hesitate, move to the next close — don't push.

QUICK PRACTICE DRILL

After your next test drive, sit the customer down and ask only the direct-ask line — then count to five in your head before saying anything else. Write down what they said.

2 The “What’s Giving You Pause?” Close

GOAL — Turn “I want to think about it” into an honest conversation about the real concern.

From the Starter Kit: Step 6 — Address Customer’s Objections

WHEN TO USE IT

The customer says they need to think about it — or they go quiet, or they start circling. This is the line for that moment. It gives them room to be honest instead of forcing a fake decision.

WHAT TO SAY

“Of course — you should feel good about this. Can I ask what's giving you pause? Sometimes talking it through helps. And whatever you decide, I'm happy to help.”

WHY IT WORKS

It works because it gives the customer permission to say no. Once they know you won't pressure them, they'll usually tell you the real reason — the payment, the trade, a family member who needs convincing. Now you have a real objection to work with instead of a polite stall.

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Arguing or pushing past the objection — or inventing a “deal” you can't deliver. Both break trust and kill the sale anyway.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Let them finish before you respond.
- ☐ Acknowledge the concern in their own words.
- ☐ Address it with facts, options, or a quick demo.
- ☐ Never promise anything you can't deliver.

QUICK PRACTICE DRILL

Practice the line out loud until it's natural — then use it on your next “I need to think about it.” Stay quiet after you ask. Whatever they name, that's the objection you solve.

3 The Choice Close

GOAL — Find what the customer actually cares about, then trade value for value to a deal both sides feel good about.

From the Starter Kit: Step 7 — Flexible Negotiations

WHEN TO USE IT

When the numbers are on the table and you're not sure what will actually move them — price, payment, trade-in, or extras. Before you start throwing discounts around, find out which one matters.

WHAT TO SAY

“Before we talk numbers — what matters most to you: the price, the monthly payment, your trade-in, or what’s included?”

“I want to find a number that works for both of us. Here’s what I can do: [offer]. Does that work for you?”

“I can’t go lower on the price, but I can add [perk]. Would that make this work for you?”

WHY IT WORKS

It stops the battle. Instead of haggling over one number, you find the thing that actually matters to this customer and trade value for value — which feels like a compromise to them and a win-win to you. And it's honest: you never promise a discount or perk you haven't been authorized to offer.

THE COMMON MISTAKE

Starting with your best offer, or giving ground without getting anything in return — you leave value on the table and the customer still feels pressured.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ Know your range before you sit down: max discount, perk list, walk-away number.
- ☐ Ask what matters most — price, payment, trade-in, extras.
- ☐ Trade value for value; move toward the win-win.
- ☐ Never promise an unauthorized discount or perk.

QUICK PRACTICE DRILL

Before your next deal, write down your maximum discount, your perk list, and your walk-away number — and stick to them. Then run the choice question on your next negotiation.

Want the Full Process?

These three closes came from The Sales Rep Starter Kit — the complete 27-page training packet that walks you through all 10 steps of the sale, from the Meet & Greet to the follow-up call. Every step has word-for-word scripts, the mistakes to avoid, a checklist, and role-play drills — plus a start-of-shift checklist, a script bank, a scorecard, a notes worksheet, a 7-day practice plan, and a quick-reference card for your pocket.

The Sales Rep Starter Kit — \$24.99 at blamoclosing.com. Use code BLAMO10 at checkout for 10% off.

ALSO IN THE STORE

The 10 Steps to the Internet Sale · The Spouse Objection Playbook · The “Pray About It” Objection Playbook · The “I Want More for My Trade-In” Playbook · The Qualifying Questions Guide · Vehicle Walk-Around Training Guide · F&I Awareness Training Manual · Prospecting Like a Professional · Meet & Greet Mastery · Follow-Up That Creates Customers for Life · Blamo Closing Leadership Academy — every add-on playbook \$6.99, Spanish versions of every title available, and the Complete Package unlocks the whole library (every current and future title) in one purchase.

Everything is honest, practical sales education — no hype, no pressure tactics, no promises of what you’ll earn. Just real dealership training that works when you work it.

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